Brett Plemons

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Pushing the Limits of Product Innovation to Deliver Optimization, Automation, Scalability, & Reliability
Unwavering commitment to continuous learning to stay at the forefront of technology advancements

- Established authority and influential leader with over a decade of progressive experience in software development and system architecture that drives innovative technological advancements and operational efficiencies across multiple platforms.
- Intentional in leveraging engineering management insight and data-driven decision-making; routinely consulted for guidance on complex IT and architectural projects, delivering solutions that align and give the organization a competitive edge.
- Leader and mentor known to inspire innovation and diverse ideas that foster individual growth within an inclusive and open culture, ultimately contributing to team engagement and performance.
- Relationship builder and cross-functional advisor consistently securing cooperation and consensus from stakeholders and leadership on critical initiatives; recognized for bridging gaps between technical and non-technical teams to drive project success.

RECENT HIGHLIGHTS & ACHIEVEMENTS

MFour Mobile Research

- ✔ Transformed engineering team performance by implementing comprehensive developer efficiency standards and observability tools, resulting in a 200% improvement in Issue Cycle time (reduced to 4 days), 182% increase in weekly issue resolution (now at 9 per week), and 385% reduction in unlinked pull requests (down to 20.9%).
- ✔ Dramatically improved development workflows by reducing PR Cycle Times by 121.1% (now 0.42 days), decreasing sprint carryover by 265%, enhancing sprint completion rate by 69.4% (now at 93.5%), and boosting sprint predictability by 37.9% (approximately 52%).
- ✔ Established robust engineering practices, including AI-powered PR agents, Design System Management (Storybook), and industry-standard style guidelines that streamlined processes while maintaining high code quality.
- ✔ Fostered cross-functional collaboration between engineering and product teams, aligning technical initiatives with strategic business objectives while maintaining focus on consumer privacy and data integrity.

Dictionary.com

- ✔ 2022 & 2023 Exceptional Engineering Award for strategic vision and innovations.
- ✔ Spearheaded a strategic overhaul in system architecture, achieving an 86% increase in data ingestion speed, 82% decrease in error rates, and 83% decrease in content release timelines (6-week to 1-week cycles), enhancing system reliability and efficiency with additional reductions in quality assurance (QA) and user acceptance testing (UAT) times.
- ✔ Directed end-to-end development and deployment of a dynamic mobile application with 2.5M users, leading to a 102% increase in user retention and a reduction in crash rates from 1.2% to 0.3% while overseeing backend services, significantly enhancing scalability, reliability, and customer engagement.
- ✔ Reduced annual expenses by over $500K for AWS cloud services through audit and redesign of infrastructure, optimizing cloud services usage and resources. Better budget utilization allowed a $2k annual education allocation for staff development.
- ✔ Led teams in KPI improvements, increasing productivity by over 30% and accelerating delivery timelines by 25%.
- ✔ Drove a 15% increase in operational efficiency through lean management.

RevLogical

- ✔ Increased employee retention by 45% by creating teams with more stability and cohesion in alignment with the company's goals; developed and implemented hiring protocols, structured interviews, and skills assessments to identify best-fit employees.
- ✔ Optimized database queries, cutting data retrieval times by 50% for critical retail operations.
- ✔ Boosted app performance, reducing load times by 30% through efficient coding practices.
- ✔ Developed a cloud-based inventory management system, enhancing tracking accuracy by 40%.

- ✔ Improved financial accuracy across 11 retail stores, reducing cash-out discrepancies by 63%; through a partnership with store managers, overhauled cash-out procedures while developing a custom point-of-sale system to minimize human error.

Kansas Dept of Health and Environment

- ✔ Optimized data workflows, cut processing time by 20%, improved data accuracy and report reliability by leading digital transformation to a Tableau-based platform and pioneering integration of R and SAS, elevating analytical capabilities.

Blue Cross Blue Shield of Kansas

- ✔ Improved client API time-to-update by 30% through optimized extract, transform, and load (ETL) processes.

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

MFOUR MOBILE RESEARCH *7/2024 to present*

Senior Engineering Manager | 2024 to 2025: Report directly to the CTO while overseeing the daily operations of our development team. Lead technical initiatives, mentor engineers, and drive innovation to enhance our SaaS platform, Studio, eliminating data blind spots in market research while respecting consumer privacy.

- Led the design, development, and deployment of complex software systems, establishing and maintaining high technical standards while fostering a culture of innovation among engineering teams.
- Implement comprehensive developer efficiency standards and observability with tools including Jellyfish, AI PR Agents, Design System Management (Storybook), and industry-standard style guidelines.
- Using data-driven metrics to systematically analyze and improve engineering processes, significantly enhancing productivity, code quality, and delivery predictability.
- Mentor and develop engineers through guidance, code reviews, and continuous learning opportunities, strengthening technical capabilities across the organization.
- Work closely with product managers, designers, and stakeholders to align engineering efforts with business objectives and product roadmaps and ensure technical initiatives support strategic goals.
- Manage engineering resources effectively, balance workloads, and set priorities to optimize team performance while maintaining focus on system reliability and scalability.
- Directed the development of a complex grammar correction tool employing T5, GECToR, and a proprietary model for identifying and correcting sentence fragments and run-on sentences.
- Oversee deployment and maintenance of production systems, ensuring high availability and performance to support clients' market research capabilities.

DICTIONARY.COM (Remote) *3/2022 to 7/2024*

Senior Engineering Manager | 2022 to 2024: I managed cross-functional teams (Backend, Mobile, Machine Learning, Analytics) while maintaining my responsibilities as a Staff Software Engineer, consistently boosting productivity and leading groundbreaking innovations across technical domains.

- Enhanced and maintained software applications using C#, .NET Core, and MS SQL Server (SSIS), ensuring high performance and scalability.
- In partnership with HR, a review system that includes bi-weekly check-ins and semi-annual 360-degree reviews was implemented to encourage constructive feedback, promote personal growth, and ensure that all voices are heard and valued.
- Designed and implemented data protection solutions, ensuring data integrity, minimizing downtime, and enhancing disaster recovery capabilities.
- Oversaw storage platforms, such as Amazon FSx and AWS S3, optimizing storage solutions for efficiency and performance.
- Led the design and implementation of an NLP application using LLM-based models (GPT-4 Turbo) for generating exemplary sentences for lexicographers, effectively decreasing their iteration cycles by 12%.
- Steered cross-functional teams while promoting skill development and enhancing productivity with KPI-driven strategies.
- Directed the development of a complex grammar correction tool employing T5, GECToR, and a proprietary model for identifying and correcting sentence fragments and run-on sentences.
- Promoted structure, efficiency, teamwork, and software development best practices by leveraging Agile, Scrum, and Jira.
- Pioneered innovations across multiple technical domains by leveraging existing and emerging technologies.
- Utilized Infrastructure as Code (IaC) technologies, including Ansible, Python, and Terraform, to automate and streamline management tasks.

DICTIONARY.COM - CONTINUED

Staff Software Engineer | 2022 to 2022: Spearheaded the transition from REST API to WebSocket-based communication for the

GrammarCoach product. Enhanced system architecture to improve scale and performance, pioneered advanced product features, and enhanced real-time user interactions and system responsiveness to meet critical business targets.

- Leveraged C#, .NET Core, and MS SQL Server to design and implement a robust document savings feature, streamlining content management and significantly improving platform reliability and user engagement.
- Harnessed Agile methodologies, including Scrum framework and Jira project management tools, to establish best practices, promote team efficiency, and drive high-quality, on-time deliverables.
- Led WebSocket integration, enhancing real-time interaction and aligning with strategic goals and business objectives.
- Developed enhancements to the content management system, increasing reliability, functionality, and user satisfaction.

REVLOGICAL, Kansas City, MO *2/2021 to 3/2022*

Engineering Lead: Led architecture and development of a high-traffic retail mobile app, supporting 10,000 concurrent users for real-time in-store price scanning, utilizing React Native, which enhanced consumer experience and operational efficiency. Led a team of 8 engineers in a cross-functional project to integrate payment solutions products seamlessly across platforms.

- Designed and implemented backend services using C#, .NET Framework, Entity Framework, LinQ, and MS SQL Server to ensure high performance and scalability for critical retail operations.
- Pioneered processes and standards for developing mobile and web applications utilizing test-driven SDLC best practices and tools, including Agile, Scrum, and Jira.
- Managed a full-stack engineering team of 8 engineers of varying levels of seniority, encompassing mobile, backend, and IoT development.
- Spearheaded the development of an IoT platform using C++ to integrate LiDAR, RFID, and Computer Vision technologies (drones and 360 cameras) for optimizing warehouse and logistics operations.
- Initiated the adoption of IoT for real-time asset tracking, improving logistics efficiency.
- Refined system security protocols to safeguard user data and comply with new regulations.
- Strategized a transition to microservices, preparing systems for scalable future enhancements.

KANSAS DEPT OF HEALTH AND ENVIRONMENT, Topeka, KS *9/2020 to 2/2021*

CONTRACT – Data Engineer: Served as a primary systems architect and technical consultant while leading the digital transformation of an on-premises web application to a dynamic Tableau-based platform, enabling advanced data analysis and visualization through direct integration with R and SAS. Developed custom dashboards and conducted thorough data audits to ensure integrity.

- Managed a team of 12 Data Scientists, MLEs, and Data Analysts to develop and distribute public health informatics on a distributed cloud platform, optimizing data workflows and enhancing report reliability.

BLUE CROSS BLUE SHIELD, Topeka, KS *2/2020 to 9/2020*

CONTRACT – Software Engineer: Led team to devise strategies for improved data integration and engineered an efficient ETL pipeline, facilitating seamless data accessibility for client APIs, boosting performance, enhancing efficiency, and ensuring operational excellence in statewide healthcare web services.

- Maintained and enhanced a .NET Framework web application utilized statewide by healthcare facilities, ensuring robust operation, improved data integration, and service continuity.

HITCHPIN INC, Manhattan, KS *8/2019 to 2/2020*

Fullstack Engineer: Drove automation, continuous integration, code optimization, and developing new features to meet the company and consumers' emerging technology demands. Utilized Agile development, including Kanban, daily stand-up meetings, and monthly refinement and sprint planning to drive team effectiveness while ensuring high quality of deliverables.

- Optical character recognition (OCR) and Python were used to verify financial account information automatically, significantly reducing manual processing time and error rate.
- Built partnerships with tech teams and stakeholders to collaborate on designing and implementing pricing algorithms and feature enhancements for a sizable agricultural eCommerce platform using Django and React.js.
- Developed a custom caching solution that increased app performance by 25%

KANSAS STATE UNIVERSITY, Manhattan, KS *10/2018 to 8/2019*

Data Specialist | 2019 to 2019: Managed enterprise-level Active Directory, conducted basic to advanced troubleshooting of software, hardware, and static enterprise networking, and maintained and updated existing Talisma enterprise database.

- Developed a streaming data pipeline with Airflow, automating data extraction, cleaning, and loading processes, leading to actionable business insights and operational efficiencies.

Research Assistant | 2018 to 2019: Innovated an automated system using OCR and Tesseract for digitizing paper invoices, enhancing document accessibility and searchability, and reducing processing time.

BEST BUY, Manhattan, KS *7/2014 to 11/2018*

Geek Squad Consultant: Led customers through technical solutions and education to resolve computer problems. Delivered support and training to team members and increased team expertise through skill development, fostering a collaborative environment.

- Streamlined operational workflows and updated operating procedures, improving service delivery and compliance.
- Created and implemented software solutions to streamline identifying, repairing, and tracking system vulnerabilities, resulting in more efficient and consistent repairs.
- Developed comprehensive training programs for check-in and repair employees, enhancing their technical skills and ensuring consistent, high-quality service delivery.
- Trained over 50 employees, leading to a 30% increase in operational efficiency.

SKILLS

Leadership, Coaching, & Training
Architecture Design & Development
API Design & Integration
Data Visualization
Service Performance Optimization
Distributed System Design
Software Engineering
Machine Learning / Data Science
Deployment & Scaling
Database Management
DevOps & CI/CD
SDLC / Agile, Scrum, Jira
Client Relationship Management
Cross-functional Collaboration
Executive Presentations
Advanced Data Analytics
Product Innovation
Cloud Technology

TECHNOLOGY PROFICIENCY

Cloud Technologies & Platforms: AWS (8+ years of experience)

Programming Languages & Frameworks: Python | JavaScript/Node.js | Go, Rust, Ruby on Rails, PHP (Laravel), Java (Spring), C# (.NET Framework, .NET Core, ASP.NET), R, SAS

Front-End Technologies: Java Script: React (Redux, Redux Saga, Thunk, Next.js), Angular5, Vue.js (Nuxt.js), JQuery HTML5, CSS

Mobile Development: iOS | Android | Cross Platform: Dart (Flutter), React Native

Database Technologies: Cassandra, Neo4j and MongoDB, MySQL, PostgreSQL, MariaDB, MS SQL Server, Redis

Network Protocols: TLS, SSH, BGP, TCP/IP, HTTP/2, QUIC

Productivity Platforms: Jira, TeamCity, Asana, Monday, Trello, Microsoft 365 (Word, Excel, PPT), Microsoft Teams, Project, SharePoint, Access | Google Suite

Other: Splunk, Tableau, PowerBI **|** Payment Processing Gateways: NMI, Plaid, Stripe, Square, Recurly

NOTE: A full technology proficiency list is available on LinkedIn.

EDUCATION, CERTIFICATIONS, & TRAINING

In Progress - BS in Computer Science (Machine Learning) & Applied Mathematics | Southern New Hampshire University (tentative completion August 2025, 9 credit hours remaining)

AWS Certified Solutions Architect

Courses completed at Kansas State University, Manhattan, KS

- Engineering Physics
- Linear Regression and Analysis of Variance: This study uses multivariate predictive modeling with linear regression to define the efficiency of different traffic light sensors. It utilizes various methods to import data (CSV, JSON, XML) and SAS.
- Probability and Statistics
- Scientific Programming in Python (Numpy, Scikit-learn, Pandas, Matplotlib, Seaborn)